

Waharaka Thero English Subs Discourse

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J5gOSX4WMhE&feature=emb_logo

How to attain Nibbana as a Buddhist Layman – Part 2

So, dukkha-dukkha, viparinama-dukkha and sankhara-dukkha, the three variants of dukkha arise this way.

Thus, we get an answer to the question, whether the worldly things that the worldly beings hold, likable and sweet or delightful, are truly worthy or not.

This likability and delightfulness is nothing but a mind made illusion, and not something that we can make up, maintain, rely on and hold on to.

A listener: It's like holding on to a quartz rock, thinking it's a gemstone.

Waharaka Thero:

If it only gives suffering and there is nothing that lives up to the expectation, we can't keep the way we want, the things that we call me, myself and mine.

Then, after seeing this we will come to know that, things have got no essence, nothing substantial, noting fruitful to be had.

"Asarattena Anatta" – since there is no essence, we call it Anatta (not worthy of owning)

But today this has been termed as "Anathma". "Athma" means existent. Having substantial qualities. Is of essence.

"Anathma" means nonexistent. Is there any other word for nonexistent?

The opposite of Athma is Anathma.

Existent is one extreme, nonexistent is the other extreme. Without associating with neither of the extremes, the Lord Buddha became enlightened, associating the medium.

"Anathma" is not the correct word, but "Anatta" is. Anatta means, of no essence.

The phrase "**Asarattena Anatta**" has been clarified this way.

What do you mean by "Asara"? It means, of no essence, of no value, nothing substantial about it.

If it is existent, or nonexistent, we shouldn't really bother.

These are the two extremes; of which we rather have nothing to do with. The physical and mental action process is of no essence.

If we are to take the meaning of "Anathma" for the word "Anatta", we fall on the "Annihilation-belief (uccheda-ditthi)", the belief in the non-existence of an ego-entity or personality, and which therefore, at the dissolution at death, will come to be annihilated.

Thus, they point that Buddhism is for Annihilation-belief. Well that is wrong, where in Dhamma has such a thing been said?

Anatta has nothing to do with "Annihilation-belief (uccheda-ditthi)" or Eternity-belief (sassata-ditthi). It means, it is of no essence.

There are things that the inept worldly beings take as likable and delightful. However, they are of no essence.

If we fall on to the existent, nonexistent argument, if we say it's nonexistent, people would say "how can you deny the presence of something, that is obviously present"

If we say it's nonexistent, then people would say, that you are on the side of the Eternity-belief (sassata-ditthi).

Then we'd get entangled in some totally unwarranted arguments.

Be that existent or nonexistent, it is of no essence.

Now how can anybody question this? Can't deny, has no accept.

The word Anicca has a linguistic expression. We call "Nirukthi". The linguistic expression is hidden, sort of encoded.

Knowledge of discrimination of linguistic expression is a part of Knowledge of a Lord Buddha. A skill coming under the four discriminations.

The cover-up the linguistic expression of the word Anicca is the problem.

The hidden meaning is not to one's liking (Iccha is liking, Anicca is not to one's liking).

Anatta, in Sanskrit it is called Anartha, in Pali is called Anatta, in Sinhalese it is called Anātha (endangering, pestering, not leading to appeasement or any assurance).

If something causes suffering, it is pestering, will not lead to appeasement. Not really concerned with whether it is existent or non-existent.

"Anātha. That is how to clarify the word Anātha. "Anatta" means the same thing,

Not worthy of holding on to. Distressing. Should you will associate, you will be doomed. No solace, no reassurance.

The Sinhala word "Anātha" suits perfectly. The utmost desperation, defenselessness, helplessness all are described in the word "Anātha".

With regard to "Anātha", it describes irremediable properties. It is much worse than helplessness. With a helping hand, helplessness can be alleviated.

When become subject to "Anātha". That will be irremediable. Cannot be put right, ever.

Likewise, what is described with the word "Anātha", will have no essence to be taken out of it. Once became subject to Anātha, it cannot be right again.

In summary the entire world is subject to Anātha. Endangering, pestering, leads to no solace.

Then what is subject to Anicca. What is not to one's liking.

The eye, we expect to keep it to our liking, we cannot keep it as likable and delightful.

We despise unpleasant things. But they do come our way. Inevitable. Thus, the eye is subject to Anicca.

What about visual objects? No matter how much likable, we cannot keep them. We encounter unpleasant visual objects.

What we like, goes away, what we don't like, comes by. Such, that, the visual object too are subject to Anicca.

Has nothing to do with being impermanent, it is not to one's liking, anicca.

The eye, visual objects, ear, sounds, nose, odors, tongue, flavours, body, bodily sensations, mind, mental objects are not to our liking.

We refer to these things as, the mental and material things (Nāmarupā) or the world.

That is why it has been said, that the world is subject to Anicca.

If something is not to one's liking, should one try to keep things to his liking, thinking falsely that he's supposed to and is able to do that, the end result would be nothing but suffering.

But the inept worldly being do just that. So, they are very much vulnerable.

The worldly beings without knowing the truth, try to build up their own world. Looking for some solace (consolação), in a world, which is inherently pestering and punishing.

How can one seek solace, in such a world? This is the truth.

A listener→ The worldly beings are helpless. By convention/norm, the world leads to distress and hopelessness...

Waharaka Thero→ Yes, now both can be seen. This we call that the worldly beings are helpless.

When someone hold on to something punishing, that's what happens?

If you get your self-freed from such distress, you see the solace. You see Buddha, who lends the helping hand for the helpless.

From Dhamma you see the Buddha: "He who sees Dhamma, sees me sees me (Yo Dhammam passati so mam passati)"

So, when you see the Buddha's reassuring helping hand, you see Buddha, you see Dhamma. Then isn't this Dhamma?

Without grabbing the helping hand the Buddha lends us, without seeing the Dhamma, What are we doing? What else we should be doing?

So, can't we see this much. Punna Dasi, got enlightened seeing this much. Even seven year olds, attained the liberation after seeing this much.

A Listener: For that shouldn't they have already got the conditions conducive to enlightenment, accumulated in themselves up to the required thresholds?

Waharaka Thero→ True, but how can we say, such people, who have already gathered enough energy are not around anymore? This little much of Dhamma, still has to be clarified.

It may seem so little, but this much lies hidden until a Lord Buddha comes and shed light upon it for us to see.

The value of these three words are that much great. Thus, more or less they remains hidden.

We need a rightly self-awakened Lord Buddha to make it visible for us.

That much precious. Since the underlying meanings got distorted with time, we were unable to access the essence of Dhamma, which grants Nibbana.

A Listener: Is it because of the lack of Arahants with the skills for the four discriminations

Waharaka Thero→ **That was the shortage. From the four discriminations (artha, dharma, nirukthi, patibhāna) only one is able to uncover the truth. Now that we know the linguistic expression of the Dhamma words, we'll come to understand its underlying meaning.**

Without understanding the correct underlying meaning, when we mix up things, confusions arise.

For example, the meaning of the word “Bhikkhu” has been clarified as the one who holds worn out and broken bowls and lives by begging.

(Por exemplo, o significado da palavra "Bhikkhu" foi esclarecida como aquele que segura tigelas gastas e quebradas e vive mendigando comida.)

Then a beggar too asked everybody to bow down in front of him

Then he said that, he too is holding worn out, broken bowls, thus he should also be a Bhikkhu

(Então ele disse que, ele também está segurando desgastado, tigelas quebradas, assim ele também deve ser um Bhikkhu→ The Buddha)

He also said that, he too is living by begging. So He claimed to be bowed down at and venerated as a Bhikkhu.

Now how can we deny the beggar’s request. The word “Bhikkhu” has been clarified as the one who holds worn out and broken bowls

The word “Bhikkhu” has been clarified as the one who lives by begging.

So according to the beggar and also by that definition given, he claimed to be attended to and be venerated similarly

If that is the definition given, can we really deny the beggar anything less than what he claims.

There is a certain linguistic expression to the word “Bhikkhu”. The problem stems from not seeing that

“Bhi” means the being. “Khu” means weakening.

Bhikkhu as in, in the process of weakening the being. With such a definition, can the beggar claim to be a “Bhikkhu”? The beggar is affixed in the being.

If there is someone, who is in the process of weakening the being, following such path that enables just that, that someone can be called a “Bhikkhu”.

The word “Bhikkhu” has its linguistic expression hinting towards its underlying meaning.

The correct linguistic expression, should come from the knowledge of meaning, a part of the four-fold knowledge of discrimination.

A Listener: Ven. Sir, I can see that you have acquired such knowledge of discrimination

Waharaka Thero: To some extent, I will not say no. I cannot deny something that is apparent.

That is why I point out key Dhamma words and take out the real meaning that lies underneath.

So there is a method to decipher the words to understand the truth conveyed by Dhamma.

Accordingly, I have deciphered the word “Bhikkhu”. But this has not been written in any books of reference, in any Dhamma commentaries as such.

“Khu” means weakening, discrediting, taking as something disgraceful, futile. When someone does that to the being, such person becomes a “Bhikkhu”.

Saying a “Bhikkhu” is someone who holds worn out and broken bowls and lives by begging, will not really work.

However, when we say a “Bhikkhu” is the one who follows the path of weakening the being, not the Beggar, not anyone, other than someone who objectively does that, can claim to be a “Bhikkhu”.

“Yada nichchan – than dukkhan; yan dukkhan – thadanaththa”. Now this phrase is all you have to get clarified.

“Rupan loke priya rupan -satha rupan,

Eththesa thanha uppajjathi,

Eththa niwissamana niwissathi-

Nirujjamana nirujjathi”

Na Chetan Karaniya sutta

Therefore, in Each instance. Now you as a person who has knowledge of Abhi-Dhamma, you might know, in Dhamma it has been said that in each Chiththakshana, there are 16 dependent origination cycles.

Then will we be able to get the doctrine of dependent origination clarified that easily?

Each Chiththakshana, before completing its arising, persisting and passing away, by the time the persisting is completed, four dependent origination cycles take place that work in four different ways.

We mainly discuss the twelve linked dependent origination cycle clarified in the Pitaka of discourses.

But in the “Vibhangaprakaranaya” (Book of treatise on divisions), there is a division for causal genesis (pachchayakara) which explains the detailed process.

This is extremely intricate, expert knowledge. Do attain Nibbana, without bothering about Abhi Dhamma. This is not for the attainment of Nibbana.

Should be used in the case of Buddha Dhamma being suppressed, to revive it.

If someone asks what is “Āyatana”, we cannot identify any definition in the discourses, nor in any other commentaries.

The eye, ear, tongue, nose, body and mind is shown as the “Āyatana”, or the six sense bases.

We know that the Lord Buddha effected the cessation of six sense bases.

With the complete eradication and cessation of ignorance, willful acts/ volitional thoughts, **viññāṇa** (consciousness) ceases; with the cessation of consciousness, mind-body ceases; with the cessation of mind-body, the six sense bases cease.

Lord Buddha eradicated ignorance fully, with detachment. One cannot deny it.

After eradicating ignorance fully, with detachment, the six sense bases have been ceased.

If “Āyatana” are the six sense bases, didn’t the Lord Buddha have the eye, ear, tongue, nose, body, mind during the 45 years he lived following attaining the supreme enlightenment.

If one question what can we say?

If “Āyatana” are the six sense bases, didn’t the Lord Buddha have the eye, ear, tongue, nose, body, mind during the 45 years he lived following attaining the supreme enlightenment.

If one questions what can we say?

Repeat(????)

See one cannot interpret Dhamma using the Discourses only, without Abhi-Dhamma one cannot clarify what “Āyatana” is.

In the “Vibhangaprakaranaya” (Book of treatise on Divisions), two questions are asked.

“Is Chakku (eye), the Chakkhayatana?

Is Chakkhayatana, the Chakku(eye)?”

The eye is the eye, not the eye base, the eye base is the eye base, not the eye”. It has been clearly clarified in Abhi-Dhamma.

Hence, can we avoid Abhi-Dhamma and get this clarified. The eye base is distinct from the eye.

To clarify this, I will first give a separate description. To understand the eye base, we have to think like this.

Our ancestors referred to our body as a cage. Referred to it as the cage of the five aggregates.

This is a fine analogy. In the past we, Srilankans had our sinhala commentaries on canonical texts. None of these has been spared, for us to refer today.

Nowadays we only have the commentaries composed by Buddhaghosa Thero. That is why some of the Dhamma concepts have been concealed (hidden).

The cage can be a good representation to explain as to how the sense bases come into being.

Fine way to show that the eye is different from the eye base.

Now suppose we buy a cage. Now we refer to that as a cage.

Now if we put in a mynah (a bird), we call it a “mynah cage”. We remove it and put in a parrot, now the cage still stands as it is, but now we call it a “parrot cage”. Likewise, we can put in different different animals, and the cage will be renamed based on the animal inside.

Now if we put in a mynah, we call it a “mynah cage. We remove it and in a parrot, now we call it a “parrot cage”. Like wise, we can put in different animals, and the cage will be renamed based on the animal inside.

The cage got renamed based on the animal inside, the cage remains as it is the only difference is the kind of animal that is kept inside.

Now we’ll consider this house. If some veterinarian functions his practice here, this house will be called a veterinarian clinic.

The house is still a house. After sometime we turn it into a bank. Now the house, although it is the same house, now will come to know as a banking institute. (21:10)

The institute became different because of the change in the function within, not because of the outward frame, that is the house.

Likewise, the eye is a cage. It has been shown as some empty cage.

The translucent, sensitive matter (prasada-rupa) has a connection with the eye of a sentient being.

The eye is analogous to an empty cage. However, driven by sensuality, if we come to associate with senses, the eye will become a sense base for the vision of sensual objects.

Until that vision of the sensual objects remains inside, it remains a sensual base. This is how the sense bases are originated.

When one wants to enjoy the sensuality of sounds, he will put his ear towards the sound, giving rise to the base similar to the eye base.

Then one day, when the desire, anger and delusion will have been annihilated, the delusion will have been annihilated, the sense bases come to be ceased. That is why the body has been shown as a cage.

To a Lord Buddha, the sense bases have been ceased, but the proverbial cage remains.

So, we are not talking about the mere vision. If there is a sensual attachment towards such vision, then the sense bases are originated from within. It has been removed the sensual attachment, not the vision or the hearing. Things will continue to be seen and heard.

Thus, the volitional impulses/ mental fabrications (Sankhāra) have to be ceased at this point. When the volitional impulses are ceased, whatever activities derived from ignorance come to be ceased as well.

With that only the sense bases come in to being. That's where the sensual attachment is formed. See how much, these intricate points have been confused. That is why Abhi-Dhamma is so much valuable.

If one tries to interpret Dhamma without it, things will get pretty messed up. It is essential for the interpretation of Dhamma. But, Abhi-Dhamma does have many deeper aspects.

A Listener: It will not really work to holding on to the concept of impermanence, by referring only to the Discourses and not to Abhi-Dhamma.

Waharaka Thero: It will not, Abhi-Dhamma contains key concepts

It's like this. Some would question, before Abhi-Dhamma was established, didn't folks attain Nibbana? They did.

Think this way. Consider a general physician. He has been told to prescribe this particular pill to this condition. He's been Taught to see the symptoms and prescribe appropriate medication. He's been told that this particular condition requires these pills having this name and these looks.

What will happen, if all different pills had the same colour, shape and weight? The pharmaceutical companies will manufacture the medicines, along with required details and instructions pasted on the cover. So, the physician will check the patient's conditions, look at suitable medications contained in named bottles and will give them to patient as required.

Let's suppose some cat jumped on to the counter and messed around with bottles and the pills having the same outwards looks got mixed up. The physician will be at a loss as to what pill he should give.

Why? The physician does not see the shape, colour, weight. But since the pills are different will he be able to sort them out?

He cannot give medicines. Because he could be giving the wrong medicine. In such instances, all the pills will have to be taken back to the pharmacist.

Then the expert will do some testing to look into the chemical composition and will sort out the different types of pills.

Abhi-Dhamma is analogous to the expert knowledge going to the chemical knowledge going to the chemical manufacturing of the medicines.

The medicines are analogous to the Dhamma, to the Discourses. Individuals have messed with the Dhamma, giving their own opinions, just like the mess created by the cat in our example.

If somebody has messed with the Dhamma, giving their own opinions, then to get things back in order, we have to trace it to Abhi-Dhamma.

In the “Ānāpāna Vinhangā” of “Vibhangaparakānaya” (Book of the treatises on Divisions), there is one important point. In Clarifying the “Ānāpānasati”, we are told of four stages called counting connection, touching, fixing”.

They tell us to count the breathing ins and outs, minding the tip of the nose or the upper lip, from one to five. From five to ten, then again counting in ascending and descending order. The counting has been given in the Visuddhimagga (the Path of Purification) as the counting of breathing ins and outs.

The connection (anupubbānā) has been given as counting one by one from one to ten in the ascending and descending order.

The touching (thupānā) has been given as minding the tip of the nose or the upper lip, where the breath is felt.

The fixing (Thapanā) has given as, unwaveringly keeping the mind focused on the same.

The Visuddhimagga has given these four methods as clarifications to the counting (ganānā), connection (anupubbānā), touching (Thupānā), fixing (Thapanā) in explaining the Ānāpānasati meditation.

Let’s say we have been following this method.

Fine. The “Ānāpāna Vibhangā” of the “Vibhangaparakānaya” (Book of treatises on Divisions), which relates to the Discourses and the Abhi-Dhamma, also talks about the counting (ganānā), connection (anupubbānā), touching (thupānā), fixing (Thapanā).

But how it has been clarified. “this is the First Jhāna, this is the second Jhāna, this is the third Jhāna, this is the fourth Jhāna”. This is the counting (ganānā).

Successive attainment of Jhānas. First attain the first Jhāna, then the second Jhāna, then the third Jhāna, then the fourth Jhāna. This has to be practiced. This is what is called the connection (anupubbānā).

The touching (thupānā), is being able to make resolutions (adhittāna) to touch the first Jhāna, then then second Jhāna. Likewise, to touch each Jhānas and move to the next.

The fixing (thapanā) is to mastery of the Jhānas. Being able to stay in the Jhānas stage as long as one desire. That is what’s been shown as the fixing (Thapanā).

Now while the Discourses, the “Vibhangaparakānaya” (Book of treatises on Divisions) written by Arahants clearly given the clarifications to the counting (ganānā), connection (anupubbānā), touching (Thupānā), fixing (Thapanā),...the Visuddhimagga talks about counting one by one, keeping the breath and the mind on the tip of the nose or the upper lip.

Now what’s the truth. Don’t you see anything strange here?

Didn’t the author of the Visuddhimagga ever happen to read “Vibhangaparakānaya” (Book of treatises on Divisions). Nope, surely he may not have read. Then how come something as straight forward as this was mixed up, with something different all together.

Why was it ever connected with the breath? See, the extent of scheming very much clear, with the ulterior motive of hindering the Âṇàpànasathi meditation of the Noble Path. See how it has been turned into something totally different.

Why was it ever connected with the breath? See the extent of scheming very much clear, with the ulterior motive of hindering the Âṇàpànasathi meditation of the noble path.
See how it has been turned into something totally different.

“Âṇàpànasathi meditation is comprehensible to profoundly wise men such as Sammâ-Sambuddhas (perfectly enlightened ones), Paccekabuddhas (“a lone Buddha”, “a Buddha on their own”, “a private Buddha”, or a silent Buddha”) or Arahants. It is not meant for unwise men.”

In the Majjhima Nikāya (“Collection of Middle-length Discourses”), the Lord Buddha has uttered these words.

Visuddhimagga says that the Âṇàpànasathi meditation is comprehensible to unwise men. Where is the consistency.

So how will it work? It Cannot be traced to the Dhamma. Visuddhimagga says one thing, the Lord Buddha says another. Why has this not been seen?

A Listener: The folks have got it all wrong, referring to the work of an ordinary monk, ignoring the those of Arahants with the knowledge of four discriminations.

Abhidhamma has been put aside saying that it came much later and it’s just the work of Arahants with the knowledge of four discriminations.

{O povo entendeu tudo errado, referindo-se ao trabalho de um monge comum(Budaghosha), ignorando os de Arahants com o conhecimento das quatro discriminações.

Abhidhamma foi deixado de lado dizendo que veio muito mais tarde e é apenas o trabalho de Arahants com o conhecimento de quatro discriminações.}

But the Visuddhimagga is being treated as the Holy Grail. To whom we should say this.

A Listener: Buddhaghosa Thero hadn’t even attained the stage of Stream enterer. Had he?

Now, had we even looked in to the historical story with our common sense, we should’ve been able to see something important.

We are of the view that the Buddhaghosa Thero had links with the Maha Vihāra (The Great Monastery) and its Theravāda lineage.

Theravāda lineage and the Maha Vihāra were connected only until such time that the Maha Vihāra got burned to the ground. When the Maha Vihāra was burning, all the monks from Theravāda lineage had to flee.

The Mahavamsa (“Great Chronicle”) claims that libraries in the Maha Vihāra was burning for seven days.

If it took seven days to burn up all those texts, didn’t we have any Buddhist scriptures, before the Tipitaka, the canonical text is claimed to have been committed to writing. This unfortunate incident arose because of some feud between the Maha Vihāra and the Abhayagiri Vihāra (Abhayagiri Monastery).

The Monks resident in Abhayagiri Vihāra, were loyal to the Kings of that time, took on designations in the governing, were trying to win over the general public.

From there another faction of Monks departed as a result of another feud and came to reside in the Dhakshinagiri Vihāra (Dhakshinagiri Monastery). There lived a Monk Called “Sagalika” with a lineage of students Monks.

The burning down of Maha Vihāra instigate riots amongst Buddhists.

The King got alarmed and promised to reinstate Maha Vihāra. It is said that black gram had been cultivated where the Maha Vihāra was standing. The Maha Vihāra got restored, but was handed over to the lineage of Monks coming from that “Sagalika” Thero.

Then in Maha Vihāra resided those monks from Dhakshinagiri Vihāra, who left Abhayagiri Vihāra due to some clash. That was when Buddhaghosa Thero came to Maha Vihāra. He never came into contact with monks from Theravāda lineage. How could something truthful have emerged from there?

The then residents of Maha Vihāra, were after personal benefits, publicity and praise. They had already setback the Noble path, were pursuing personal agendas to build up their names.

So how we get this issue of the commentaries sorted out? What has been clarified in the commentaries.

31:21 The Pali Canon is correct. Monks of those days, went to places like Alulena in Maathalé, committed the Canon in to writing and kept them hidden everywhere. Since the Pali Canon was there, although hidden, when the time was right, it came out alright.

When the commentaries were written, they were done as preferred. The meanings got distorted. Now we can't sort out the canonical meanings properly.

31:34 **A Listener:** That happened due to the loss of knowledge of four discriminations, right?

Waharaka Thero: That is why, if such individuals were there, the Pali Canon would be more enough.

A Listener: Now since the knowledge of linguistic expression got lost, it was difficult to decipher the work of Arahants.

Waharaka Thero: Exactly, you can't. Thus, if one has

(1^a) the discrimination of meaning (artha).

(2^a) discrimination of phenomena (dharma)

(3^a) discrimination of linguistic expression (nirukthi)

(4^a) discrimination of exposition (patibhāna),

Waharaka Thero: When you see the Pali Canon, you will easily know the path of Dhamma. You will know what has been falsified. And this why? Both can be identified.

Because of this, this is correct, and because of this, this is wrong. Can be clarified.

Towards the end of Kālāma Sutta, it has been said that “one who is a disciple of the noble ones, acquires four assurances (Assāsa)”.

“Now, Kalamas, one who is a disciple of the noble ones – his mind thus free from hostility, free from ill will, undefiled, and pure – acquires four assurances in the here-and now. There we have a place which clarifies the word “Assāsa”. It means assurance.

“Sathowa assasathi”. It doesn't mean to breath mindfully. It says to obtain the “Assāsa” or assurance. There we have the assurance, something reassuring.

There will be four types of assurances available to a disciple of the noble ones.

Because, while becoming a disciple of the noble ones, he will abandon ill deeds. He isn't going to commit the five sins, which give the worldly beings hostility, and ill will.

33:12 He does this not based on any false view. He sees wrong doings for what they are and comes to realise that those should not be carried out, through the understanding of Dhamma.

He does this not based on any false view. He sees wrong doings for what they are and comes to realise that those should not be carried out, through the understanding of Dhamma of Dhamma.

Those days there had been many different views. Other religious men, came and preached all sorts of everything.

Some said that there is a world after death, if there is the fruit of actions rightly and wrongly done and one should refrain from doing wrong actions.

Now there is no need for a stream enterer to hear such words and to refrain from sinning.

A stream enterer would say "It doesn't matter whether there is a world after death or not, whether there is, or there is no fruit of actions rightly and wrongly done, I am renouncing wrong actions, simply because they are wrong"

A Listener: "With his gaining of insight he abandons three states of mind, namely self-illusion, doubt, and indulgence in meaningless rites and rituals, should there be any."

Waharaka Thero: Yes, that insight has been attained. Some other preachers said that, "there is no world after death, and there is no fruit of actions rightly and wrongly done"

"So what? am renouncing wrong actions, simply because they are wrong, not because there is no world after death, or there is no fruit of actions rightly and wrongly done."

This is the second assurance that he acquires.

Some others said, "Evil is done through acting; thus the evil doer is the sinner"

"So what? I am anyway renouncing wrong actions; it doesn't matter if the evil doer is a sinner or not. I have nothing new to bear from your teachings." This is the third assurance that he acquires.

34:52 Some others said, "No evil is done through acting; thus the evil doer is not the sinner"

"So what? I am anyway renouncing wrong actions, simply because they are wrong; it doesn't matter if the evil doer is not a sinner or is." This is the fourth assurance that he acquires in here-and-now.

These are the assurances. "acquires four assurances". These are what's acquired.

There is a discourse called Assāsa Sutta. Assāsa Sutta and param' Assāsa Sutta.

If a monk, while factually keeping track of udayamgama (rising), atthagama (continuance/ growth), assāda (optimum), ādīnava (decay starts), and nissarana (last stage leading to passing away) with regard to the sense-faculties, what has to be drawn in (assurances) are fulfilled."

In this dispensation, the assurance is not something that is taken in and let out. It is something that is fulfilled.

If a Monk, while factually keeping track of udayamgama (rising), atthagama (continuance/growth), assāda (optimum), ādīnava (decay starts), and nissarana (last stage leading to passing away)...with regard to the eye sense-base, tongue sense-base, body sense-base, mind sense base, what has to be drawn in (assurance) are fulfilled."

This is a place where what needs to be drawn in, what assurances need to be fulfilled has been clarified. This is what needs to be drawn in mindfully. (satova assasati)

What are the assurances that need to be fulfilled? One has to see the affiliating contact of the eye. There is a contact that is taken from the eye, additionally there is also an affiliating contact.

What makes a contact (passa), an affiliating contact (samphassa)?

Mere contact is not enough, need to be affiliated with the sense object.

Why? Because of ignorance and desire. See that is how sense-bases come to be.

Affiliating contact of eye, affiliating contact of ear, that is how they come to be.

When affiliated with ignorance and desires, perceived as worthy of holding on to, the affiliating contact becomes.

We have to see this rising (udayamgama) of the six sense bases. Nowadays, this has been clarified as the rising and collapsing.

Udayamgama means the rising.

Atthangama means how the continuance is manifested,

Assāda is optimum state where it is entertained.

Ādinava means the starting of the decay,

From how the progresses, one

Needs to see the bad consequences.

Then nissarana is the last stage leading to passing away. It is no more.

37:21 – to everything, to the eye-ear-tongue-nose-body-, as well as to visual objects-sounds-odors-favours-touches-mental objects.

All worldly things are the manifestation of the recurring process of arising, continuance, optimum, decaying and passing away, over and over again.

Let it to be eye-ear-tongue-nose-body, internal or external, all phenomena are manifested from arising. Arose. There is a threshold to the arising, once there, it's arisen. Then it continues and comes to the optimum stage and then it starts decaying, and with the passing of time, it passes away.

This recurring process to all worldly phenomena, when seen factually, what needs to be drawn in (assurances) will have been fulfilled.

This is what need to be associated with. One associates Dhamma to come thus far.

Now we'll reflect on this. Arising – a baby is conceived. From there on starts to grow. The child is born. Until the age of 16, the child is in the stage of arising.

Grows up, after the age of 16 or 17, the growth will be sideways not upwards. The body has been grown. It's in the stage of continuance or growth.

Now in the optimum stage, the teen starts pursuing pleasures. After that, comes to the middle age, comes to the stage of decay. Then dies, the stage of passing away.

Between the birth and death, the process of arising, continuance (growth), optimum, decaying and passing away takes place.

No sentient being escapes this phenomenon.

One plants a mango seed. Arising. It sprouts, grows up to some height, after that it will grow sideways. That is the continuance/ growth.

Then the tree bears fruits, sweet or sour.

This is the optimum stage. Then with time the leaves become slender, the branches start to fall off, the stage of decay. Then the tree dies, the passing away.

The same actuality befalls the mango tree, or cash tree, the jack tree, the coconut tree, whatever. All the material objects of the world, even us. Subjected to the same actuality

Whatever arising, is subject to the process of arising, continuance, optimum, decaying and passing away, flowing, flowing continuously, over and over again like a river...

No one can stop it, it is norm, the actuality, the law and order of things.

When you see the actuality for yourself, what will be done next?

What needs to associated (assurances) has been drawn in, associated with. Assured.

Then is anything worthy of owning, to call it me, mine, myself. Whatever we call it, can we keep it the way I like. What to call mine. Mine is merely a hollow word, isn't it?

Just because if hope for will it work? Nope. Merely in flows through and perishes a continuum of arising, continuance (growth), optimum, decaying and passing away.

Although we call it, me, mine, it will not stop. You can call it the king's, the god's, the Brahma's. No way, it will stop, can't be stopped. That is the norm, the actuality.

Once you have seen the actuality for what it is. the assurances are fulfilled. This is what needs to be realized. The drawing in of Dhamma not air. This much has been clearly laid out in the discourses, where does it refer to the air.

Once you have seen the actuality for what it is, the assurances are fulfilled. This is what needs to be realized. The drawing in of Dhamma not air. This much has been clearly laid out in the discourses, where does it refer to the air.

A Listener: Venerable Sir, isn't it because Venerable Ananda didn't ask the Lord Buddha to be for the entirety Maha Kalpa (an eon), the Lord Buddha's death occurred? Is it inconsistent with what you have been saying?

Waharaka Thero: No it's not like that, a Buddha could have prolonged his life to a full eon (Ayu-Kalpa/ life span), can't live forever, can he?

In the process of arising, continuance (growth), optimum, decaying and passing away, then the Lord Buddha was in the stage of decay.

The Lord Buddha, clearly mentions this. Feeling cold, the Blessed one was warming in the sun, 80 years old.

Seeing the state of the Lord Buddha's physique, Venerable Ananda said, "It's amazing, Lord. It's astounding, how the Blessed One's complexion is no longer so clear and bright; his limbs are flabby and wrinkled; his back, bent forward; there's a discernible change."

"That's the way it is, Ananda. Even as an old cart, Ananda, is held together with much difficulty, so the body of the Blessed one is kept going only with supports. It is the norm, the actuality."

Lord Buddha has clearly pointed out what will happen to our physique, and even the physique of the Blessed one was no exception. Simply the manifestation of the arising, continuance, optimum, decaying and passing away.

Could have prolonged his life to a full eon, due to his practice of the four bases to success. Could have prolonged, but not forever.

Kalpa/ eon here means, Ayu-Kalpa/ life span. Kalpa means the time span. If it's for the earth, it would be a Maha Kalpa.

A Listener: In times, where the Lord Buddhas were staying up to 80.000 years of age, the life span would have been 80.000.

Waharaka Thero: Yes, if is life, a life span (Ayu-Kalpa). Kalpa of something means the time span of its existence.

A Listener: Then because living between 600 – 2.000...(illegible)

Waharaka Thero: Yes, that is true. There are many aspects to things that we don't know of.

Waharaka Thero: The person with the physical body, can create a metaphysical body and get out of the physical body. That is something only a person with supernatural knowledge (Abhijñña) can do.

That metaphysical body could be mastered, without the need of a physical body. Live with it, eating and drinking with it, even solidifying when required.

That person sees that the physical body of flesh and blood consists of thirty-two varieties of impurities (dethis kunapa) and is exhausting. Thus, leaving it aside he hangs on to the metaphysical body

Then all creepers would grow all over that physical body, though the hands and all. The physical body remains still like a skeleton, going into decay. This happens to yogis in particular.

The physical body of flesh and blood goes in to decay, while he lives in metaphysical body.

The metaphysical body can be mastered, and he will live in that throughout its life span.

But even the metaphysical body has its expiry day as that is subject to arising, continuance (growth), optimum, decaying and passing away.

A Listener: They say that there are monks living up to 600 years even quite possible nah? But that may be using the metaphysical body, not the physical body of flesh and blood, like we presumed. There are so many of such people among the Arahants of those days, having supernatural knowledge (Abhijñā) such as venerable Dabba Malla Putta.

He could arrange seats for even hundreds of monks within few minutes. He created multiple bodies of himself and all of them could function separately, doing the task at hand in no time. They had such extraordinary capabilities.

Those were metaphysical bodies, having metaphysical abilities.

Those with supernatural knowledge could create any number of metaphysical bodies. Venerable Chulla Panthaka created thousand metaphysical bodies. All functioning independently, talking independently.

But since they have fully annihilated ignorance and have fully seen the fruitless nature of the worldly things, they do not wish to be even in those metaphysical bodies.

The Yogis however, lives long lives in such metaphysical bodies that they have created for themselves.

Since they have no idea what Anicca, Dukkha, Anatta is, they don't see that their efforts in fact go in vain.

Couldn't the Blessed One have done even greater things. He simply could have, but he, obviously knew better and had different ideas.

The Buddha had declared to Mara, "I would not die until, the four kinds of disciples (Bhikkus, Bhikkunis, laymen and laywomen) have come to be true disciples of the Blessed One – wise, well disciplined, apt and learned, are able to expound it, preach it, proclaim it, establish it, reveal it, explain it in detail, make it clear; and when adverse opinions arise, are able to refute them thoroughly and well, and to preach this convincing and liberating Dhamma"

"This is the purpose of living for a **Buddha**, beyond that there is no need for me to live.

I Have no desire to and I am not living because I want to”

Forty-five years after uttering those words, Mara came to the Lord Buddha, when Venerable Ananda was also present:

“Now, O Lord, the four kinds of disciples (Bhikkus, Bhikkunis, laymen and laywomen) have come to be true disciples of the Blessed One – Wise, well disciplined, apt and learned, preservers of the Dhamma, are able to expound it, preach it, proclaim it, establish it, reveal it, explain it in detail, make it clear; and when adverse opinions arise, are able to refute them thoroughly and well, and to preach this convincing and liberating Dhamma”.

“And now, O Lord, such has already been achieved. Therefore, O Lord, let the Happy One utterly pass away! The time has come for the Parinibbana of the Lord”

“Mara, the Blessed One has become successful. Do not Trouble yourself. Before long the Parinibbana of the Tathagata will come about. Three months hence the Tathagata will utterly pass away.

Now here it clearly shows, that a Buddha is born and lives in this world, not because of the ignorance and desire to live. The Blessed One has a mission to accomplish. He will live until the point it’s achieved.

But until such time comes, nobody can kill a Buddha. The most one can do is to draw blood. Beyond that no harm can be done to a Buddha.

As a Bodhisattwa, our Lord Buddha has fulfilled perfections through four asamkhya kalpas (incalculable ages) and a hundred kalpas. Owing to the sheer power of the perfections fulfilled, a Buddha cannot be killed.

This is not in contravention of the process of arising, continuance (growth), optimum, decaying and passing away. Whatever formed, will go through this process throughout its rightful life time.

Arises, then grows, in the optimum stage the intended function is carried out, in the stage of decay, things will become much harder and then it duly passes away eventually.

With regard to the Gothama Buddha’s dispensation even, the same thing actualizes. It arose, it continued to grow. In the optimum time, at the peak of its glory, the wrong views were shattered and the right views established, doing the sentient beings invaluable service.

Then it came to the stage of decay, gradually going in to decline, and presumably at the end of 5.000 years it will pass away. A Buddha’s dispensation will be no more.

Each and every worldly thing, is subject to the actualization of arising, continuance (growth), optimum, decaying and passing away.

If this is the norm, how can we rely on any thing that came in to being. Doesn’t matter how it seems, nothing is glorified. It is one big delusion.

The only thing good about, these worldly things is, that we can understand them, their true nature, them being subject to arising, continuance (growth), optimum, decaying and passing away. We should be determined, to accomplish the **Noble Path**, before this being that we are in now, passes away. Only that could be the possibly meaningful purpose for our otherwise petty lives. That is the conclusion we have to reach to.

Then one comes to realise that there is nothing worthy to hold on to. What to hold on, where can anything be that is worthy of holding on to. There is no such thing in the world.

One sees the norm, the actuality. From there onwards, he come to realise that he can’t keep anything to his liking, as the status of all things are governed by respective law and order of things, the convention.

Then why did we struggle for, to achieve what. Had we struggled in this infinite samsaric journey, what have we achieved thus far.

If we are struggling even now, that is also to do the impossible only. A mission impossible. The struggle will be put to as rest and the future actions will be put to a rest and the future actions will be based on factual comprehension of things.

“Let things be and will not fight what will be. I am doing what need to be done, to obtain the factual comprehension of things”.

Accordingly, achieves the understanding of Dhamma, leaving out all sorts of worries aside.

That is the final conclusion.